AIMoniPoint

The AI Career Roadmap.

A practical, step-by-step guide to building AI skills that pay, from your first lesson to your first client.

01 The three AI skill tracks compared

02 What to learn at each stage, beginner to advanced

03 Portfolio projects small businesses actually pay for

04 Six income streams, and which to start with

05 Your 90-day action plan

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STEP 1 · CHOOSE YOUR TRACK

Three tracks. Pick one.

The biggest early mistake is trying to learn everything. Each track below can pay on its own. Choose the one that fits you best, and go deep for 90 days.

	AI Automation	AI Agents	AI Software Development
YOU BUILD	Workflows that move data and do repetitive work with AI	Systems that plan, use tools and complete tasks with approval steps	Full AI apps and products with logins, data and your own interface
BEST FOR	Non-coders, operators, freelancers and anyone who wants the fastest route to a first paid project	People comfortable with logic who want to work on harder, higher-value problems	Developers, data professionals and technical founders
CODING	None needed to start	Python helps a lot	Python or JavaScript/TypeScript
CORE TOOLS	n8n, Zapier, Make, ChatGPT, Claude, Google Workspace, Airtable	Python, Claude Agent SDK, OpenAI Agents SDK, LangGraph	Next.js, TypeScript, FastAPI, OpenAI and Anthropic APIs, pgvector, Vercel
FIRST OFFER	Automate one painful task for a small business	A lead-qualifying or booking agent	An AI assistant built on a company's own documents

Still not sure? Use this quick test.

No coding experience, and you want results quickly? Start with AI Automation.
You enjoy logic and already automate things? Move to AI Agents.
You can already code? Start with AI Software Development.

STEP 2 · BUILD SKILLS IN ORDER

What to learn, and when.

Move to the next stage only when you can do the current one without following a tutorial.

Stage 1 · Beginner: get useful fast

AI Automation

Triggers, actions and data mapping. Calling an AI step inside a workflow. Prompts that return clean output.

Zapier or Make, ChatGPT, Claude, Google Sheets

AI Agents

How models work: tokens, context and cost. Tool calling. What makes an agent different from a chatbot.

Python basics, an LLM API, Pydantic

AI Software

How LLMs fit into software. Your first API call. System prompts and templates. Streaming responses.

OpenAI or Anthropic API, Next.js or FastAPI

Stage 2 · Intermediate: build things people use

AI Automation

Self-hosted workflows, webhooks and error handling. Classifying and routing with AI. Connecting CRMs.

n8n, Docker, Airtable, HubSpot, Slack

AI Agents

Memory, planning and tool design. Approval steps for risky actions. Structured reports with sources.

Claude Agent SDK, OpenAI Agents SDK, LangGraph

AI Software

Structured outputs. Embeddings and RAG over your own documents. Logins and per-user limits.

pgvector, FastAPI, TypeScript, auth providers

Stage 3 · Advanced: reliable enough to charge well

AI Automation

Monitoring, retries and cost control. Packaging workflows as a repeatable service with a monthly care plan.

n8n in production, Postgres, logging

AI Agents

Multi-agent systems. Exposing company data safely through MCP. Tracing and evaluating agent behaviour.

MCP SDKs, LangGraph, CrewAI, Langfuse

AI Software

Evaluating answer quality, tracking cost per request, caching, containers and production deployment.

Docker, Langfuse, Vercel, Cohere Rerank

The rule that saves months

Learn just enough to build the next project. Then build it. Every skill above sticks faster when you need it for something real.

STEP 3 · PROVE IT, THEN EARN

Projects that pay. Streams that last.

Your portfolio should look like solutions to business problems, not like tutorial exercises. Build two or three of these.

AUTOMATION

AI inbox assistant

Classifies incoming email and drafts replies for a person to review.

AUTOMATION

Invoice-to-spreadsheet pipeline

Reads invoice fields with AI and logs them automatically.

AUTOMATION

Support ticket router

Classifies, prioritises and routes tickets with an AI summary.

AGENTS

Research agent

Searches approved sources and produces a structured, cited report.

AGENTS

Operations agent

Completes tasks with internal tools, with approval steps for risky actions.

SOFTWARE

Docs Q&A with citations

Upload documents, ask questions and get answers with sources.

SIX INCOME STREAMS

1. Freelance projects

One-off chatbots, automations and agents for small businesses.

2. Monthly retainers

Maintain and improve what you build, for a predictable monthly fee.

3. Your own AI agency

Package your services and build a small team.

4. Templates & products

Sell your best workflows, prompts and agent kits again and again.

5. AI micro-SaaS

A small AI product that solves one problem well, on subscription.

6. AI roles & contracts

Use your portfolio to land remote or local AI work.

Which should you start with?

Start with **freelance projects**: they pay soonest and teach you what businesses actually want. Add a **retainer** to every project you deliver. Once you've solved the same problem a few times, turn it into a **template or product**.

STEP 4 · TAKE ACTION

Your 90-day action plan.

Set aside 6 to 10 hours a week. Tick these off in order.

DAYS 1–30

Learn

- [ ] Choose one track and write down why
- [ ] Set up your tools and accounts
- [ ] Finish Stage 1 of your track
- [ ] Build one small working project end to end
- [ ] List 10 small businesses near you, or in a niche you know, and one task each could automate

DAYS 31–60

Build

- [ ] Build two portfolio projects that solve real business problems
- [ ] Record a 2-minute demo video of each one
- [ ] Publish a simple portfolio page and update your LinkedIn profile
- [ ] Offer one free or low-cost pilot to a real business, in exchange for a testimonial
- [ ] Write a one-paragraph case study: problem, what you built, what changed

DAYS 61–90

Earn

- [ ] Package one clear service with a fixed scope and a price
- [ ] Contact 5 potential clients a week with a specific idea for each
- [ ] Book discovery calls, and send a short written scope after each one
- [ ] Deliver your first paid project, and offer a monthly care plan alongside it
- [ ] Ask for a testimonial and a referral

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